



CLIENT TRAINING · ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT · BRAND GROUNDWORK

Sound Like Yourself. Everywhere.

Brand & Voice in Verilume: why one approved voice beats a hundred good briefs, what the Brand Book gives you, and the seven steps that make every campaign, press release and video script sound like you wrote it.

Read time: 15 minutes · Setup time: about an hour · Payback: every piece of copy after

SESSION ONE

The brief nobody writes twice

Here is a scene I've watched play out at more companies than I can count. A new campaign kicks off. Someone opens a blank document and writes, for the fourth time this year, three paragraphs about "who we are and how we sound." An agency reads it. A freelancer reads a different version. The email team never sees either. Six weeks later, the campaign ships sounding like three different companies.

The problem was never talent. It was that the brand lived in people's heads and in scattered documents, and every piece of work started by re-explaining it. Verilume's Brand Groundwork ends that. You describe the brand once — the words that are you, the words that are never you, your colors and type — and an AI drafts a Voice Guide you approve. From that moment, every campaign, Ad Hoc project, press release, video script and copy contest reads that guide before it writes a word. Nobody re-explains the brand. Nothing ships sounding like it came from three agencies.

What changes when the voice is approved

Without an approved Voice	With one
Every draft opens with generic, safe copy. The AI literally tells you: tone is "generic and direct, since this account hasn't approved a Brand Voice yet."	Every draft opens in your register — your vocabulary, your restraint or your energy, your rhythm.
Words you'd never say slip into copy and someone has to catch them by eye.	Your Terms to Avoid are enforced. Copy is checked against them and flagged automatically.
Colors and fonts get re-asked by every designer and vendor.	Primary color, heading and body type live in one place and travel with every creative brief.
The brand drifts a little with every campaign.	Every approved version is kept. You can mark one as the reference and roll back anytime.
You can't create a campaign until someone writes the brief.	Brand Groundwork is the front door: finish it once and campaign creation opens for good.

The stakes

A brand is a promise repeated until it's believed. Repetition is the whole game, and repetition at scale is impossible when the source of truth is a person's memory. This hour of setup is the difference between a brand that compounds and one that starts over every quarter.

SESSION TWO

What's in the box

Brand Groundwork is one page with two halves, a version history, and a contest that lets the AI models compete for your voice.

1. The Brand Book — Voice

Three short lists and one AI-drafted document. **Brand keywords** (the emotional, voice and style words that are you — "a handful of distinctive words work best") and **Product keywords** (what you sell). **Terms to avoid** — words or short tone phrases that are never you: "cheap", "budget-airline chipper". **Terms to emphasize** — "restraint", "poetic precision, not promotional excitement". From those, **Generate Voice Draft** writes a Voice Guide you can edit, with a "Why this draft?" panel explaining its reasoning and a "To improve this draft" panel listing what it wished it had.

2. The Brand Book — Colors & Fonts

Primary color (name and hex), heading font and body font are the core. Logo files (SVG, PNG or WebP under 2 MB), logo usage rules, secondary palette, color hierarchy and misuse, typography hierarchy and style notes are optional and worth filling in — style notes is where your visual do's and don'ts live. If you already have a brand guide, **Upload Brand Guide** (.docx, .doc, .pdf, .txt, .md) pre-fills the colors and fonts and pulls a voice excerpt into the draft.

3. Version history and "What we observed"

Every approved Voice Guide is kept. Mark any version **Reference**, **Applied** or **Removed** (a reason is required to remove). Below it, **What we observed — and what it changed** lists nine input signals — keywords, terms to avoid, sample writings, website examples, competitive positioning and so on — showing whether each was on file and whether it actually shaped the draft. It's the honest answer to "what is the AI working from?"

4. The Voice Contest

A separate page where five AI models each write a headline and a paragraph in your voice, presented blind. You rate them without knowing which model wrote what. Once every option is rated you can reveal the AI Brain's alignment scores, save a winner, and press **Generate updated Voice Guide from this winner**. The winner's Vision Statement and Longform Example become account-wide brand context, and the winning model becomes the default for future Voice Guide drafts.

One page, many doors.

You'll find Brand Groundwork under Account Management → your company's Configuration, on the Dashboard's Brand Groundwork module while setup is incomplete, and under AI Agent Training → Brand Style. Same page every time.

SESSION THREE

The seven steps to an approved voice

The Configuration sequence walks you through it in order — Company Overview, Brand Book, Sample Writings, Website Examples, Competitive Positioning, Marketing Budget Upload, Team — with Back and Next at the bottom of every page. These are the Brand Book steps.

01 Start from what you already have

If you have a brand guide, upload it first (**Upload Brand Guide**). It pre-fills Colors & Fonts and seeds the voice draft. Then read what it mapped — the page asks you to check it, and you should. A guide written for print designers often says nothing about tone, and that's fine; the next steps cover it.

02 Choose your words — Brand & Product Keywords

Add brand keywords as chips: the emotional, voice and style words that are unmistakably you. Resist the urge to list twenty. Five distinctive words beat twenty generic ones — "restrained", "warm", "exacting" say more than "professional", "innovative", "customer-focused". Product keywords come pre-drafted from your assessment answers; correct them. **Refresh suggestions** asks the AI for more; chips save the moment you add or remove them.

03 Draw the lines — Terms to avoid, Terms to emphasize

Terms to avoid is the most powerful list on the page because it is enforced, not just recorded: campaign copy is checked against it. Put in the words competitors use that you don't, the tone you've had to delete from drafts before, the clichés of your category. Terms to emphasize is the mirror — the ideas you want returned to again and again.

04 Generate the Voice Guide and edit it like an editor

Press **Generate Voice Draft**. It's a real AI call and can take up to a minute. Read the "Why this draft?" reasoning, then edit the guide as you would a colleague's draft: cut what isn't you, add the one sentence only an insider would write. Check "To improve this draft" — if it says sample writings would help, that's Session Four's job.

05 Approve it — Save For AI Assistance

Two buttons, one distinction that matters. **Save Draft** keeps your edits and approves nothing. **Save For AI Assistance** approves the guide and makes it live context for every AI feature. Only the second one counts. Teams stall here for weeks because someone saved a draft and assumed they were done.

06 Colors & Fonts — same two buttons

Primary color, heading font, body font at minimum; logo and the optional fields if you have them. **Save For AI Assistance** here too. This is the second of the three approvals the platform needs before your first campaign.

07 Run the Voice Contest

Open the Voice Contest page and press **Start new contest**. Rate all five candidates before looking at the alignment scores — that's the point of blind judging. Save the winner and press **Generate updated Voice Guide from this winner**. Then re-approve the updated guide (step 5 again). You've now chosen not just a voice but the model that best writes it.

The gate, explained.

Before your first real campaign, three approvals are required: Brand Book — Voice, Brand Book — Colors & Fonts, and Competitive Positioning. Click Create Campaign without them and the platform sends you to the first missing one. After your first campaign exists, the gate never blocks again — but the voice still drives everything, so keep it current.

SESSION FOUR

Where your voice shows up

Once approved, the Voice Guide is read by more features than most clients realize. This is the list — so you know what you're improving every time you sharpen it.

Feature	What it takes from Brand Groundwork
Campaign messaging copy and copy scoring	The full Voice Guide; Terms to Avoid as a compliance check on every draft.
Campaign Copy Interview	The Voice Guide shapes the questions the AI Brain asks and the copy it drafts.
PR / Corporate Communications, LinkedIn posts from press releases	The Voice Guide.
Video strategy and video scripts	The Voice Guide.
Voice Contest (all five models)	Keywords, terms to avoid/emphasize, sample writings, website examples.
Campaign Brief Builder tones; Search Everywhere	Brand keywords.
Creative briefs and wireframes	Primary color, fonts, logo rules.

Coaching notes from the field

Fewer, sharper keywords.

The best Voice Guides I've seen came from clients who chose five words and argued about each one. If a keyword could describe your competitor, it isn't doing any work.

Terms to avoid is where the brand actually lives.

Anyone can list what they are. Naming what you refuse to be is what makes copy recognizable. Ten minutes on this list is worth an hour anywhere else.

Save Draft is not done.

Only "Save For AI Assistance" approves. If the Dashboard still shows the Brand Groundwork module, something is still unapproved.

Mind the weekly contest budget.

The Voice Contest shares a weekly cap of 20 AI-contest runs per account with the Creative Job, Campaign Copy and PR Copy contests. Run the Voice Contest once or twice, decisively — don't burn the week's allowance on it.

Revisit after every rebrand, not after every campaign.

The guide should be stable. Change it when the brand changes; use Version history to mark the current reference so the team knows which one is live.

SESSION FIVE

Who does what, and your checklist

Role	Owns	When
Brand / marketing leadership	Approves the Voice Guide and the Colors & Fonts; judges the Voice Contest.	Onboarding; after any rebrand.
Brand manager	Keywords, terms to avoid/emphasize; edits the draft; keeps Version history tidy.	Onboarding; reviewed quarterly.
Design lead	Colors & Fonts, logo files and usage rules, style notes.	Onboarding; when identity assets change.
Content / copy team	Reads the approved guide; flags copy that gets through against Terms to Avoid so the list improves.	Ongoing.

Setup checklist

Item	Where
Brand guide uploaded (if you have one) and its mapping checked	Brand Book
Brand keywords chosen — five to eight distinctive words	Brand Book → Module 1
Product keywords corrected	Brand Book → Module 1
Terms to avoid entered — including category clichés	Brand Book → Module 2
Terms to emphasize entered	Brand Book → Module 3
Voice Guide generated, edited, and approved with Save For AI Assistance	Brand Book → Voice
Primary color, heading font, body font saved with Save For AI Assistance	Brand Book → Colors & Fonts
Logo uploaded (SVG/PNG/WebP) with usage rules	Brand Book → Colors & Fonts
Voice Contest run, winner saved, updated guide generated and re-approved	Voice Contest
Brand Groundwork module no longer showing on the Dashboard	Dashboard

The closing thought

Your competitors can copy your offer. They can't copy the way you say it — unless you leave it undefined, in which case the market defines it for you. An hour here and the platform says it your way, every time, without being asked.

Questions or a walkthrough with your team: reach your Verilume account lead.